

The Mouth of Fools Doth God Confess

(also known as Although the Fools Say with Their Mouth)

Words: Martin Luther, 1524. Translated by Richard Massie, 1854, alt.
Es spricht der Unweisen Mund' from Walter's Geistliche Gesangbuchlein, 1524. Setting: Michael Praetorius, 1610.
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♩ = 120

1. The mouth of fools doth God confess, But while their lips draw nigh Him,
 2. The Lord looked down from his high tow'r On all man-kind be-low Him,
 3. But none there was who walked with God, For all a-side had slid-den,
 4. How long, by fol-ly blind-ly led, Will ye op-press the need-y,
 5. There-fore their heart is ne-ver still, A fall-ing leaf dis-mays them;

Their heart is full of wick-ed-ness, And all their deeds de--ny Him.
 To see if an-y owned His pow'r, And tru-ly sought to know Him;
 De-lu-sive paths of fol-ly trod, And fo-llo-wed lusts for-bid-den;
 And eat my peo-ple up like bread? So fierce are ye, and greed-y!
 God is with him who doth His will, Who trusts him and o--beys Him;

Co-rupt are they, and ev-ery one A-bom-in-ab-le
 Who all their un-der-stand-ing bent To search His ho-ly
 Not one there was who prac-ticed good, And yet they deemed, in
 In God they put no trust at all, Nor will on Him in
 But ye the poor man's hope des-pise, And laugh at him, e'en

works hath done; There is not one well-do--er.
 Word, in-tent mood, To do his will in earn-est.
 haugh-ty mood, Their deeds must sure-ly please Him.
 trou-ble call, But be their own pro-vi-ders.
 when he cries, That God is his sure com-fort.

6. Who shall to Israel's outcast race From Zion bring salvation?
God will himself at length show grace, And loose the captive nation;
That will he do by Christ their King; Let Jacob then be
glad and sing, And Israel be joyful.